



Over
2,000 women
in **60 villages**
belonging to
12 communities
practising over
70 distinct
hand embroidery
styles


shrujan®

SINCE 1969

It has been more than half a century since Shrujan fell in love with the embroideries of Kutch. During the initial years, our focus was on reviving the craft so that it could become an economic lifeline for craftswomen living in remote villages.

Rural women look after their homes, fields, and cattle. We do not disturb their daily routine. Our ingenious production system enables the craftswomen to work from home. We reach fabrics and threads to them right at their doorstep. They do not pay for the materials. But Shrujan pays them their fair dues for their skill and time, as soon as they have completed the embroidery.

This care and concern has forged a deep bond. The craftswomen and Shrujan are a family. And, in our extended family are weavers, thread suppliers, base drawing artists, and many others, all of whom make a significant contribution to every Shrujan product. Even so, it is the embroidery craftswomen who catch the limelight. They feel proud to be regarded as artists. And we are proud to have the third, and in many instances, the fourth generation of craftswomen in the Shrujan family: great grandmothers, grandmothers, mothers, and daughters – each generation teaching the next to use the skill in their hands to stand tall on their feet.

Shrujan craftswomen are also aware of their role in making the craft sustainable. They have learnt to regard embroidery as a life skill, to be consistently practised at the highest level of excellence, so that Shrujan can maintain its strong presence in the marketplace.

Sustainability requires Shrujan to constantly create new and fresh designs that are not part of the traditional repertoire. It overwhelms us that far from saying ‘no’ to change, the women understand our intentions, welcome and participate in creating the innovations. They remind us that embroidery has a trusting heart as well as an intelligence that understands the need for change that brings in newness and at the same time respects and retains the essence of each embroidery style.

Trust, respect, generosity, togetherness – so any life lessons from a craft rendered with an itsy-bitsy needle and some coloured threads. These lessons give us the courage to face good times and bad: the Shrujan family has endured a war, cyclones, droughts, an earthquake, and a pandemic. Through it all, embroidery has been the constant companion. As a young craftswoman tells us: *Embroidery gives me comfort, it gives me joy. Sometimes a tiny ray of light, sometimes a rainbow. A ray or a rainbow, I am happy with both.*

Life
lessons
from a
beloved
craft.

A CONSCIOUSLY CRAFTED STORY

